

$$\Delta(x) = (x \otimes 1)e = e(1 \otimes x)$$

$$\Delta = \text{diagram 1} = \text{diagram 2}$$

The diagrammatic equation shows that the comultiplication Δ is represented by two equivalent configurations of strands. In the first configuration, a vertical strand has a dot at a certain height; from this dot, a curved strand arches to the right and then continues as a vertical strand. In the second configuration, a vertical strand has a dot at the same height; from this dot, a curved strand arches to the left and then continues as a vertical strand. The two configurations are separated by an equals sign, indicating they are equivalent representations of the same operation.